

the whole AI chip manufacturer using too much water thing is ridiculous

Posted by u/TheRealDrNeko • 0 points • 21 comments

yeah, AI chips needed water like how your art supplies need wood? arent chip manufacturers able to use the same water covering 71% of earth, sands that you can find in the desert, while your art supplies literally use finite resources such as wood, oil, lead, graphite the allocation of which leads to habitat destruction?

<https://preview.redd.it/s0myjcenuhfd1.png?width=499&format=png&auto=webp&s=500f4bcb283666df7f57f6037c641b5cfa0415fd>

Comments

u/twilsonco • 1 points • 2024-08-01 05:12 UTC

For the communities around large data centers, the water use is significant. It doesn't mean much to them that, elsewhere, water is more plentiful.

u/ImagineAHappyBoulder • 1 points • 2024-07-31 23:45 UTC

This is such a stupid argument. We replace the trees we chop down for commercial purposes. Planting a tree, watering it, and then chopping it down for lumber leaves a positive influence on the planet at all points in the process. Using that same water for computer time is a waste, it goes in the toilet when you decide ChatGPT didn't help you code.

u/jib_reddit • 1 points • 2024-07-30 10:02 UTC

Using the AI chips uses a lot of water because they use evaporative cooling, here is a great video about it:

<https://youtu.be/tJYSzc7YkY0?si=ZrJNncafBjQgd5oT>

It is a problem worth thinking about.

u/TheRealDrNeko • 2 points • 2024-07-30 13:50 UTC

I've watched the video and it says datacenters from AWS, Google, DigitalOcean report they recycle the same water or either use water from non drinkable sources, and if they do use drinkable sources, they are shifting to non drinkable sources, they also are starting to implement free cooling architecture to limit or eliminate use of water completely

u/jib_reddit • 1 points • 2024-07-30 16:25 UTC

The say they want to, but Google alone used 5.2 billion gallons of water last year a 20% increase on the amount the year prior.

u/EngineerBig1851 • 1 points • 2024-07-30 05:27 UTC

Taiwan is a world capital of processors. If they want - they can boycott everyone with a computer, or a phone, or any electrical device, and even then Taiwan then will still make chips for industry.

u/Treat_Street1993 • 2 points • 2024-07-30 04:37 UTC

I work in chip manufacturing, yes it's very resource intensive. 10 tanker trucks minimum full of highly toxic chemicals and gasses are getting used everyday at a typical fab. Hundreds of thousands of gallons of water are used for dilution and rinsing everyday. These places have massive water treatment plants on site.

What's silly is to differentiate "AI chips". Like, I'm not generating AI pictures on my phone with a special new chip, that's just my phones web browser chip accessing the Bing server. The real big consumers of chips will always be cars anyways.

u/doatopus • 1 points • 2024-07-30 01:26 UTC

Just tell them to quit their computers, smartphones and any other modern electronics.

u/EncabulatorTurbo • 11 points • 2024-07-29 23:52 UTC

Country prioritizes company worth 25% of the nation's GDP instead of domestic, noncompetitive agricultural industry

Shocker

u/[deleted] • 1 points • 2024-07-29 22:34 UTC

[removed]

u/PrintingShark • 3 points • 2024-07-29 21:47 UTC

Most water is consumed by completely different sectors, show them this overview next time, even if it probably won't help. Which is not to say that you shouldn't save water, by the way, but you can see what most of the water is used for.

[https://preview.redd.it/g4mobtf03jfd1.jpeg?](https://preview.redd.it/g4mobtf03jfd1.jpeg?width=2048&format=pjpg&auto=webp&s=240080733fa531618e339e694b7b9d0eccda39e4)

[width=2048&format=pjpg&auto=webp&s=240080733fa531618e339e694b7b9d0eccda39e4](https://preview.redd.it/g4mobtf03jfd1.jpeg?width=2048&format=pjpg&auto=webp&s=240080733fa531618e339e694b7b9d0eccda39e4)

u/EncabulatorTurbo • 1 points • 2024-07-29 23:57 UTC

If you put just "ai chips" on there it would be too small of a slice to see

u/PrintingShark • 1 points • 2024-07-30 00:10 UTC

I even opened an extra topic, but it's being mercilessly overrun by antis, which was to be expected.

[\[https://www.reddit.com/r/aiwars/comments/1efcytc/saving_water_is_important_but_can_we_realise_that/\]](https://www.reddit.com/r/aiwars/comments/1efcytc/saving_water_is_important_but_can_we_realise_that/)

[\(https://www.reddit.com/r/aiwars/comments/1efcytc/saving_water_is_important_but_can_we_realise_that/\)](https://www.reddit.com/r/aiwars/comments/1efcytc/saving_water_is_important_but_can_we_realise_that/)

u/JustInternetNoise • 3 points • 2024-07-29 19:26 UTC

It is true that production of chips uses alot of water but the production of chips for AI doesn't use any more water that normal.

u/AccomplishedNovel6 • 39 points • 2024-07-29 18:44 UTC

Local anti blames thing common to all industries on ai in particular. In other news, water remains wet.

u/michael-65536 • 7 points • 2024-07-29 18:33 UTC

They were 'forced' to grow less in the sense that they were paid not to.

Oh the humanity! Free money ? Those monsters!

u/Bitter_Afternoon7252 • 2 points • 2024-07-29 18:09 UTC

im sure taiwan can get some rice from china

u/EncabulatorTurbo • 1 points • 2024-07-29 23:54 UTC

Taiwan's entire agricultural sector is like 4% of just TSMC's output

u/MikiSayaka33 • 4 points • 2024-07-29 17:59 UTC

I just dismissed this argument. It's because I know that my organic art tools, especially my digital tools, are environmentally unfriendly to certain degrees.

u/ADimensionExtension • 24 points • 2024-07-29 17:57 UTC

I would avoid a trap of this argument. Wood isn't finite: Companies like Crayola and other manufacturers will grow their own trees for sustainability. And Pencil don't use lead, only graphite. Yes it still costs resources. But including wood is going to get eye rolls.

Water sustainability isn't a certainty (remember we're talking freshwater, not oceans), but there's definitely bigger fish to fry than chip manufacturing.

u/McCaffeteria • 1 points • 2024-07-30 21:38 UTC

Wood is renewable, but it's a lot less tenable than water is, and it's infinitely less tenable in this context.

The water being "used" by data centers and semiconductor manufacturing is mostly used for *cooling.* It's like measuring the flow rate of your liquid cooled PC's pump and claiming it's "using" that much water per second or whatever. It just doesn't even make any sense.

u/Mage_Hunter • 2 points • 2024-07-30 05:07 UTC

>Companies like Crayola and other manufacturers will grow their own trees for sustainability.

This is mostly lip service - old growth forests take hundreds of years to develop and are torn down and replaced with monoculture new growth - it's "sustainable" to the extent that new trees are theoretically planted but the habitat loss is very much real and largely permanent on the timeline needed for the animals which lived in the old growth. Monoculture tree plantations are not nearly as good for the environment or the preservation of species that rely on specific, heavily interconnected ecosystems to survive.

u/EncabulatorTurbo • 4 points • 2024-07-29 23:52 UTC

Gaming industry? TSMC makes chips in just about every single thing in the world with a screen on it

u/sawbladex • 1 points • 2024-07-29 20:40 UTC

Honestly, I think it is only compelling if people compare energy usage per whatever the effective unit of measurement for a technology

Crypto has to compete with the modern financial system, and sucks in comparison to that in terms of transaction time and energy cost per transaction, and hasn't even approached the same level of usage as the modern financial system

I will admit that I don't know what makes sense for the alternative for AI stuff, but machine learning in general gets used because it makes economic sense, so the power costs are offset by a benefit.

u/EncabulatorTurbo • 1 points • 2024-07-29 23:54 UTC

Crypto is as close to a pollution machine made by captain planet villains as is possible to exist, but AI doesn't even enter in as a rounding area to the energy usage of crypto